THE ENTERPRISE - WINTER FREEZE

Final Playbook: Acquisition Packets, Action Timelines, Risk Register, and Source Ledger

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RULE OF THIS DOCUMENT: Facts only. Every material line carries its evidence status and the date checked. Items not yet known appear as TO VERIFY with the exact action that verifies them. No projections, no invented numbers, no optimism.

I. WHY THESE FIVE PROPERTIES

Selection required four gates: (1) acquisition cost at or under $1,000 per parcel with a hard ceiling; (2) a documented government source (tax-sale.info official catalog, county surplus list, county land bank, county GIS) checked October 14-15, 2026; (3) at least two identified exit paths that do not depend on appreciation; (4) purchasable without bidding drama - either over-the-counter, land bank offer, or a sealed maximum bid. Everything that failed a gate was benched, including properties that looked exciting but rested on assumptions.

II. HOW THE DOWNSIDE IS CAPPED (AND THE HONEST CAVEAT)

No investment is loss-proof. This playbook caps the damage instead: (1) losing any sealed bid costs exactly $0 - the discipline is to walk away; (2) every maximum price is set at or below the lowest DOCUMENTED value anchor for that parcel, never the highest; (3) no improvements, no tree cutting, no neighbor contact before ownership and title review; (4) total at-risk capital across all five targets is under $3,000 at the stated ceilings; (5) the one completed-sale comp in this playbook ($22,000, January 2025, Lakewood bundle, 2.42 ac) is the only resale price in the document treated as a market fact - every other value anchor is an assessment used for screening only, and is labeled as such. If a deal only works using optimistic numbers, the deal is rejected, not adjusted.

III. MASTER TIMELINE

WHEN	WHAT
Oct 15-22	All verification calls (per-packet actions); register at tax-sale.info; confirm auction rules in writing
Oct 22-29	Land bank application submitted; max-bid sheet LOCKED; no changes after Oct 29
Oct 30, 10 AM-7 PM EDT	Sealed bids submitted at max prices. One submission per parcel
Nov 2 (per auction info)	Winners determined; payment and deed deadlines follow tax-sale.info terms - confirm exact dates at registration
November	Title reviews on every won parcel; MI Treasury surviving-interests list checked on each
Nov-Dec	DNR forester referral (Copemish); lot combinations (Sugar Springs); first-dibs neighbor letters ONLY after title (W Lakewoo
Dec-Mar	Firewood/cut-on-shares revenue path operates independently of land purchases (requires signed access agreements - no
Apr-Jun	Spring resale listings at comp-supported prices

PACKET 1: Pentwater Village Lot (Oceana County)

BUY NOW – county surplus, first-come | Asking/max: $500 flat

Verified Facts

FIELD	VALUE	EVIDENCE
Listing	Oceana County 2026 surplus (over-the-counter) list	VERIFIED 2026-10-14, re-confirm at purchase
Price	$500 flat, no auction	VERIFIED 2026-10-14
Assessed value (SEV)	$16,400	VERIFIED from surplus listing 2026-10-14
Parcel ID	Not yet captured - obtain from Oceana County Treasurer at purchase	TO VERIFY
Utilities	Village of Pentwater water/sewer expected at street - not yet confirmed	TO VERIFY with village office

Action Manual (step by step)

WHEN	ACTION
This week	Call Oceana County Treasurer (via oceana.mi.us) - confirm lot still available, exact price, purchase process, payment form
This week	Call Village of Pentwater office - confirm lot dimensions, utilities at street, zoning, short-term-rental rules
Before purchase	Confirm no village special assessments pending
At purchase	Obtain parcel ID, receipt, and deed; calendar the recording
After deed	Title review; if resale planned, photograph lot; list in spring
Ongoing	Annual taxes: confirm new assessment after purchase

Risks

Lot dimensions and utilities not yet verified; STR rules unknown; village lots can carry special assessments.

Maximum Price

$500 plus required fees. No negotiation needed - the price is flat. If unavailable, move on immediately.

Exit Paths

Resale as village building lot; or hold for private STR use if village rules permit (verify first).

PACKET 2: W Lakewood 6-Lot Bundle (Muskegon County)

BUY NOW - Land Bank offer, board approval | Asking/max: $1,000 offer (max $1,500)

Verified Facts

FIELD	VALUE	EVIDENCE
Parcel ID	61-06-404-067-0009-00	VERIFIED - Muskegon County GIS, 2026-10-15
Legal	Lakewood Addition No 4, Lots 9-14, Block 67 (six platted lots)	VERIFIED - county tax records
Size	0.34 acres (approx 156 ft x 101 ft)	VERIFIED - county GIS geometry
Owner	Muskegon County Land Bank Authority	VERIFIED - county GIS owner field
Zoning	HDR - High Density Residential: single-family and two-family by right, accessory buildings by right, B&B; by special use; camping is not a listed use	VERIFIED - Fruitland Twp ordinance Art. VIII, 2026-10-15
Environment	Zero wetland polygons on parcel; nearest EGLE Part 201 site 0.60 mi (risk undetermined)	VERIFIED - NWI + EGLE queries, 2026-10-15
Neighbors	1461 W Lakewood $182,900 SEV; 6194 Whitehall Rd $158,200 SEV; 1433 W Lakewood $143,100 SEV	VERIFIED - county assessor, 2026-10-15
Completed-sale comp	2.42-acre Lakewood bundle sold $22,000, January 2025	VERIFIED - prior Muskegon County research; reconfirm via land bank records
Tree coverage	Substantial mature trees observed by operator; species and volume NOT yet inventoried	OPERATOR-REPORTED - forester cruise required before any timber value is assigned
Water table	Modeled ~658 ft elevation, flow west toward White Lake, low fit (R2 0.17) - treat as indicative only	MODELED - well records, 2026-10-15

Action Manual (step by step)

WHEN	ACTION
This week	Call Muskegon County Land Bank 231-724-6170 - confirm the bundle is available for purchase application, ask process and board timeline
This week	Submit purchase application with $1,000 offer (max $1,500 if countered)
While pending	Fruitland Twp zoning office: confirm septic feasibility questions for 0.34 ac, accessory building rules
On approval	Pay, record deed; calendar taxes
After deed	Title review including any surviving interests (MI Treasury list applies); boundary confirmation (Jet geometry task running: jet_task_1792062193318_tckafr)
After title	Only then: thin trees (if desired), prepare first-dibs neighbor letter (template in this packet), or list at comp-supported price

Risks

Septic feasibility on 0.34 ac unverified; board may reject or counter; neighbor interest is UNVERIFIED until contacted (do not contact before ownership); timber volume unknown.

Maximum Price

$1,500 absolute ceiling; walk away above that.

Exit Paths

1) Sell to adjacent owner (first-dibs letter). 2) Resell as residential lot - supported by the $22,000 completed bundle sale nearby. 3) Hold as land bank (near-zero carry while county-owned status transitions; taxes re-assess after purchase - confirm).

PACKET 3: Copemish 4.17-Acre Woodlot (Manistee County)

SEALED BID - Oct 30 auction | Asking/max: Min bid $100; max bid $300

Verified Facts

FIELD	VALUE	EVIDENCE
Auction lot	Manistee Lot 4406	VERIFIED - tax-sale.info catalog, 2026-10-15
Parcel ID	04-036-275-04 (per listing; full PIN format at registration)	VERIFIED from lot listing 2026-10-15
Legal	W 1/2 E 1/2 E 1/2 SE 1/4 NW 1/4 lying S of M-115, Sec 36 T24N R13W, 4.17 acres more or less	VERIFIED from lot listing 2026-10-15
Assessed value (SEV)	$37,800	VERIFIED from lot listing 2026-10-15
Prior auction result	Offered earlier this season at $29,607 minimum - no bids received	VERIFIED - tax-sale.info prior catalog, 2026-10-15
Auction format	Sealed maximum bid; window 10:00 AM - 7:00 PM EDT Oct 30, 2026	VERIFIED - tax-sale.info, 2026-10-15
Access	Position south of M-115; legal access NOT yet verified	TO VERIFY - Manistee County Road Commission + survey
Timber	Vegetation not yet inventoried; no timber value may be claimed until a cruise is done	TO VERIFY - DNR Forest Stewardship forester referral

Action Manual (step by step)

WHEN	ACTION
By Oct 22	Call Manistee County Road Commission: legal access status for parcel south of M-115, Sec 36 T24N R13W
By Oct 22	Request DNR Forest Stewardship forester referral for a timber cruise (no cost)
By Oct 29	Review county aerial imagery; drive by if time permits - view from public road only, do not enter
Oct 30, 10AM-7PM	Submit sealed bid at your max ($300 ceiling). One submission. No bid-day changes
If won	Deed + payment per tax-sale.info deadlines (confirm exact deadline at registration)
After deed	Survey if metes-and-bounds boundary unclear; title review; THEN forester cruise and harvest planning

Risks

Legal access unverified - this is the single deciding fact. Timber volume unknown. Metes-and-bounds parcel may need survey. If access fails: parcel becomes a negotiation project or a total write-off at $300.

Maximum Price

$300. The $37,800 SEV is the county's assessment, NOT a sale price - do not let it inflate the bid.

Exit Paths

1) Buildable acreage if access verifies. 2) Timber/firewood revenue after professional cruise. 3) Sale to adjacent owner for access/aggregation.

PACKET 4: Sugar Springs Assembly (3+ Adjacent Lots) (Gladwin County)

SEALED BID - Oct 30 auction | Asking/max: Min bid $100/lot, max $150/lot

Verified Facts

FIELD	VALUE	EVIDENCE
Auction lots	Gladwin Lots 7218 and 7222 verified; additional adjacent lots identified in catalog	VERIFIED - tax-sale.info, 2026-10-15
Parcel IDs	060-091-000-485-00 (Highlander Realm No 2, Lot 485; SEV $3,300); 060-160-000-038-00 (Queens Realm Sub, Lot 38; SEV $4,300)	VERIFIED from lot listings 2026-10-15
Prior auction result	Offered at $1,932.53 and $1,750.58 minimums - no bids	VERIFIED - prior tax-sale.info catalog, 2026-10-15
Auction format	Sealed maximum bid; 10 AM - 7 PM EDT Oct 30	VERIFIED 2026-10-15
Adjacency	Whether catalog lots are physically adjacent to each other is NOT yet verified	TO VERIFY - Gladwin County GIS before bidding
Association	Sugar Springs POA dues amount NOT yet verified	TO VERIFY - POA before bidding

Action Manual (step by step)

WHEN	ACTION
By Oct 22	Map all Sugar Springs catalog lots in Gladwin County GIS; identify a cluster of 3+ adjacent lots
By Oct 22	Call Sugar Springs POA: dues per lot, transfer rules, any pending special assessments
By Oct 29	Gladwin County/zoning: minimum lot size for a single dwelling on combined parcel
Oct 30	Sealed bids on the ADJACENT cluster only - never a single lot
If won	Title review; lot combination application with county; list combined parcel in spring
Before any sale	Disclose dues honestly to buyers - dues properties sell to specific buyers, not everyone

Risks

Dues are recurring carry; the sub has many competing low-price lots; buying non-adjacent lots by mistake destroys the assembly thesis.

Maximum Price

$150 per lot, 3-5 lots max ($750 total ceiling).

Exit Paths

1) Combined-parcel resale. 2) Individual lot sales to neighbors within the sub. 3) Camp/recreation hold (verify POA rules).

PACKET 5: Michaywe Lot 33 (Otsego County)

SEALED BID - Oct 30 auction | Asking/max: Min bid $100; max bid $400

Verified Facts

FIELD	VALUE	EVIDENCE
Auction lot	Otsego Lot 6101	VERIFIED - tax-sale.info, 2026-10-15
Parcel ID	011-510-000-033-00 - Michaywe No. 1, Lot 33	VERIFIED from lot listing 2026-10-15
Assessed value (SEV)	$900	VERIFIED from lot listing 2026-10-15
Auction format	Sealed maximum bid; 10 AM - 7 PM EDT Oct 30	VERIFIED 2026-10-15
Prior auction result	Not yet researched for this specific lot	TO VERIFY at registration
Lot size	Not captured from listing - approximately 0.4 acres per plat class	TO VERIFY - Otsego County GIS
Association	Michaywe POA dues amount NOT yet verified	TO VERIFY - POA before bidding

Action Manual (step by step)

WHEN	ACTION
By Oct 22	Otsego County GIS: lot dimensions, road status (paved/seasonal), confirmed frontage
By Oct 22	Michaywe POA: dues, building rules, short-term rental policy
By Oct 22	District health dept: septic feasibility on the lot size
Oct 30	Sealed bid, $400 ceiling
If won	Title review; list in spring at sub-supported price; or hold as camp (verify POA camping rules first)
Ongoing	Calendar dues and taxes; dues delinquency causes exactly the foreclosure cycle we are buying from

Risks

Small lot septic fit; dues carry; STR rules unknown.

Maximum Price

$400.

Exit Paths

Resale to cabin-builder buyers in the sub; neighbor sale; personal camp if POA rules permit (verify).

RISK REGISTER + SOURCE LEDGER

Standing Risk Rules

1. Tax deeds are marketable under MCL 211.78 but do NOT extinguish everything - surviving interests can include easements, private deed restrictions, certain governmental environmental liens, and future special-assessment installments (MI Dept. of Treasury). Title review on every parcel, before improvements. 2. BEA filings are not automatic - they apply to qualifying properties with specific deadlines (EGLE guidance); screen first, hire professionals when warranted. 3. Sealed-bid discipline: the max price sheet is the bid. 4. No speculative improvements. 5. Dues properties: verify POA dues BEFORE bidding. 6. Camping/STR uses are township-specific and often not permitted - verify in writing.

Source Ledger (all checked 2026-10-14/15 unless noted)

SOURCE	USED FOR	URL
tax-sale.info /listings catalogs + lot pages	Oct 30 sealed-bid inventory, min bids, parcel IDs, legal descriptions, SEVs, prior-cycle no-sale minimums	https://www.tax-sale.info
tax-sale.info /auctions page	Bid window 10 AM-7 PM EDT Oct 30, 2026	https://www.tax-sale.info/auctions
Oceana County 2026 surplus list (via tax-sale.info catalog)	Pentwater lot $500; SEV $16,400	https://www.tax-sale.info
Muskegon County GIS (maps.muskegoncountygis.com)	W Lakewood bundle geometry, owner, neighbors SEVs	https://maps.muskegoncountygis.com
Fruitland Twp Zoning Ordinance, Article VIII (HDR)	Permitted uses by right and special use	https://fruitlandmi.gov/wp-content/uploads/2021/11/ARTICLE-VIII-HIGH-DENSITY-RESIDENTIAL-DISTRICT.pdf
EGLE RRD OpenData (gisagoegle.state.mi.us)	Part 201 / UST / brownfield proximity queries	https://gisagoegle.state.mi.us/arcgis/rest/services/EGLE/RRDOpenData/MapServer
USFWS National Wetlands Inventory	On-parcel wetland polygon intersect test	https://www.fws.gov/program/national-wetlands-inventory
Muskegon County Land Bank	Purchase application contact 231-724-6170	https://www.muskegoncountymi.gov
MI Dept. of Treasury foreclosure guidance	Surviving interests under tax deeds	https://www.michigan.gov/treasury
EGLE BEA guidance	Baseline Environmental Assessment applicability and deadlines	https://www.michigan.gov/egle

Neighbor First-Dibs Letter (draft template - send ONLY after ownership and title review)

Dear [Owner name], I recently purchased the vacant lot at [address] (Parcel [PIN]). I am reaching out to you first, as the nearest neighbor, before I list it. If you have ever wanted more yard, privacy, or a buffer, this is your chance before it goes to the open market. [X] acres. Asking $[price]. I can be reached at [phone]. - [Name]

END OF PLAYBOOK. No purchases, bids, or contacts are authorized without the owner's explicit go. Determination picks the acreage. Evidence picks the price.